

Two ends, one loop.

the brand book

Two ends, one loop. The lemniscate's warm end (Ember) is the human act: the hand word, the key cable, the call to action. Its cool end (Signal, on the Midnight hue) is the structure: lines, diagrams, data. Midnight is the space they connect across.

Connection, drawn as one line

Infinite is a canvas where anything patches into anything. The mark is a single closed line with two ends of one colour field. Every surface uses those two ends and the space between them.

Ember, the warm end

The human act: the hand word, the key cable, the one call to action. Hue 38. One per frame, under 10% of its area.

Signal, the cool end

Structure: lines, diagrams, data, focus, selection. Hue 276, on the same hue as Midnight so it never fights the ground.

Midnight, the space

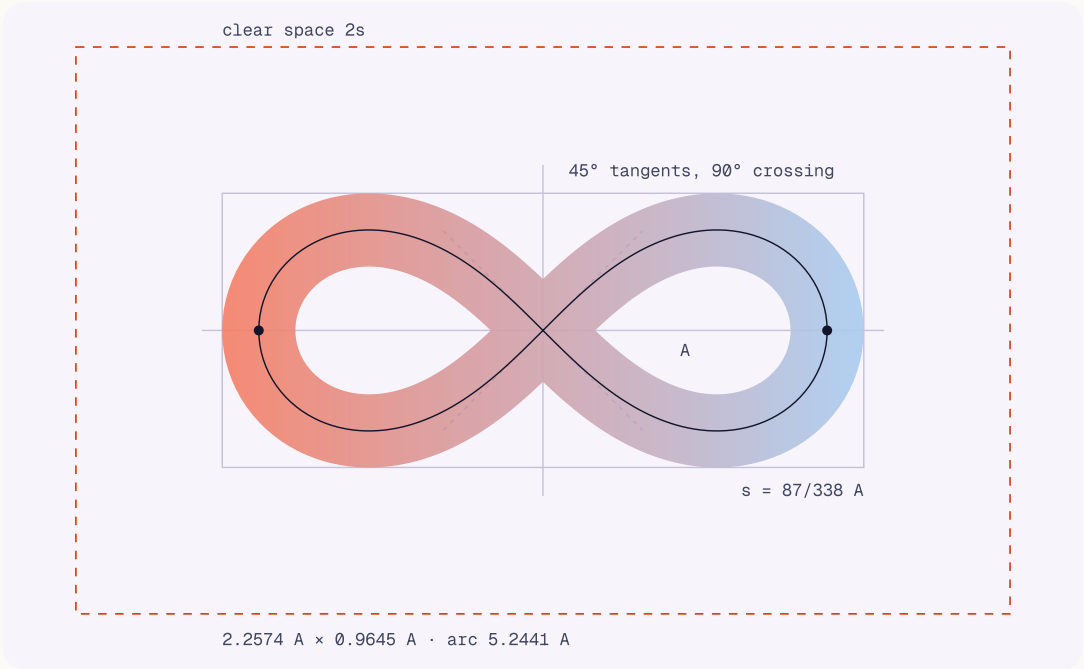
Every neutral sits on hue 274: Midnight grounds, Moon inks, Mist and Paper for reading. Never pure black or white.

Personality

calm, precise, a little playful, confident, never hype. The line: **A DAW for you.**

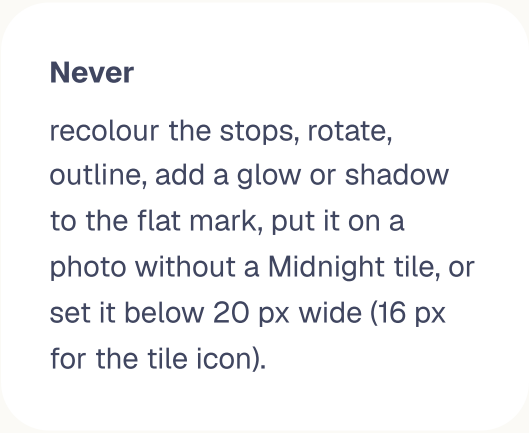
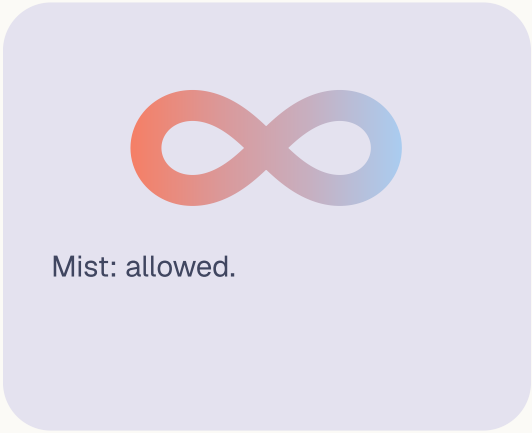
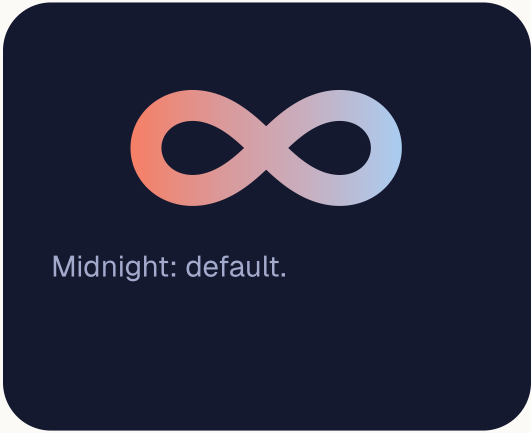
A lemniscate of Bernoulli

Lemniscate of Bernoulli: $x = A \sin p / (1 + \cos^2 p)$, $y = A \sin p \cos p / (1 + \cos^2 p)$, p in $[0, 2 \pi)$. The stroke is $87/338$ of A , so the mark keeps its weight at every size. Draw it from the formula, never trace it.



MEASURE	VALUE
stroke	0.2574
stroke ratio	87/338 of A
width	2A + s = 2.2574 A
height	A / sqrt(2) + s = 0.9645 A
aspect	2.341 : 1 with stroke (2 sqrt 2 : 1 for the centre line)
arc length	5.2441 A (2 x lemniscate constant 2.62206)
crossing	the branches cross at 90 degrees, each at 45 degrees to the axis
clear space	2 s on every side
min size px	mark 20 px, icon 16 px
tile	ground #151930 px, corner 0.185 px, mark_width 0.74 px, _doc Measured from the shipped 1024 icon (assets/Infinite.iconset) by tools/brand/build_logo.py --check. The shipped tile is #1D223B; the next icon install moves it to Midnight #151930. px

On every ground



Three families, three modes

Every colour is set in OKLCH so lightness steps look even. Anchors (marked) are the owner-approved values from the v0.5 films; the rest of each ramp is generated on the same hue.

Midnight H 274

50 #F2F5FE L0.97 C0.01	100 #E4E7F4 L0.93 C0.02	200 #CCD0E2 L0.86 C0.03	300 #B0B6CD L0.78 C0.03
400 #969DB7 L0.70 C0.04	500 #787F9B L0.60 C0.04	600 #616783 L0.52 C0.04	700 #464C65 L0.42 C0.04
800 #2D3246 L0.32 C0.04	ANCHOR 900 #151930 L0.22 C0.05	ANCHOR 950 #0D1020 L0.18 C0.03	

Neutrals: grounds, surfaces, inks. Never pure black or white.

Signal H 276

50 #F2F5FF L0.97 C0.01	100 #E1E7FF L0.93 C0.03	200 #C4CEFF L0.86 C0.07	ANCHOR 300 #A7B1FF L0.78 C0.11
400 #8795F4 L0.70 C0.14	500 #6974DC L0.60 C0.16	ANCHOR 600 #4A54D6 L0.52 C0.20	700 #3A3E9D L0.42 C0.15
800 #252572 L0.32 C0.13	900 #15144F L0.24 C0.10	950 #0B0934 L0.18 C0.08	

Structure: lines, diagrams, data, focus, selection.

Ember H 38

50 #FFF2EE L0.97 C0.02	100 #FFE0D7 L0.93 C0.04	200 #FFC0AC L0.86 C0.08	300 #FF9878 L0.78 C0.13
ANCHOR 400 #FF6B35 L0.70 C0.19	ANCHOR 500 #D9430E L0.59 C0.19	ANCHOR 600 #B53700 L0.52 C0.17	700 #872700 L0.42 C0.14
800 #5C1800 L0.32 C0.10	900 #3C0C00 L0.24 C0.08	950 #260500 L0.18 C0.06	

The accent: one look-here per frame.

Modes

One mode per scene or page section. Midnight for showcase, film and social; Mist for diagrams; Paper for reading. Roles, not hexes, go into designs.

Midnight

Dark. The default for films, social, thumbnails and showcase sections. The logo tile colour.

The cable is the point.

Secondary text sits on ink-2.

ink-3 · 120 BPM · 4.00 ms

DownloadSignal link

ground#151930deep#0D1020

surface-1#20263Fsurface-2#2A3052

surface-3#343B5Eline#343B5E

ink#EEF1FAink-2#A3AACB

ink-3#8890B1signal#A7B1FF

accent#FF6B35accent-ink#FF6B35

Mist

Light, cool. Diagrams, science plates, panels shown on light, docs headers.

The cable is the point.

Secondary text sits on ink-2.

ink-3 · 120 BPM · 4.00 ms

DownloadSignal link

ground#E4E2EFdeep#D8D5E5

surface-1#F7F5FBsurface-2#FFFFFF

surface-3#EEEDF6line#C4C1D9

ink#12152Aink-2#404660

ink-3#5A6180signal#4A54D6

accent#D9430Eaccent-ink#B53700

Paper

Light, neutral. Reading surfaces: website body, docs, PDFs, manuals, release notes.

The cable is the point.

Secondary text sits on ink-2.

ink-3 · 120 BPM · 4.00 ms

DownloadSignal link

ground#FBFAF6deep#EFF0F4

surface-1#FFFFFFsurface-2#FFFFFF

surface-3#F5F5F8line#DAD8E6

ink#12152Aink-2#404660

ink-3#5A6180signal#4A54D6

accent#D9430Eaccent-ink#B53700

Contrast gate

The build fails if any pair below misses its ratio. APCA Lc is shown for perceptual sense only (WCAG 3 has no contrast method yet).

MODE	TEXT	ON	WCAG	NEEDS	APCA LC	
midnight	ink	ground	15.32	12	-97	pass
midnight	ink	surface-1	13.19	12	-95	pass
midnight	ink-2	ground	7.56	7	-55	pass
midnight	ink-2	surface-1	6.50	6	-54	pass
midnight	ink-3	ground	5.50	4.5	-42	pass
midnight	ink-3	surface-1	4.73	4.5	-40	pass
midnight	signal	ground	8.55	4.5	-62	pass
midnight	signal	surface-1	7.36	4.5	-60	pass
midnight	accent	ground	6.10	3	-47	pass
midnight	accent-ink	ground	6.10	4.5	-47	pass
midnight	accent-ink	surface-1	5.25	4.5	-45	pass
midnight	on-accent	accent-ink	6.10	4.5	+49	pass
mist	ink	ground	14.08	12	+88	pass
mist	ink	surface-1	16.64	12	+99	pass
mist	ink-2	ground	7.26	7	+75	pass
mist	ink-2	surface-1	8.58	6	+86	pass
mist	ink-3	ground	4.75	4.5	+64	pass
mist	ink-3	surface-1	5.62	4.5	+75	pass
mist	signal	ground	4.65	4.5	+63	pass
mist	signal	surface-1	5.50	4.5	+74	pass
mist	accent	ground	3.45	3	+53	pass
mist	accent-ink	ground	4.68	4.5	+62	pass
mist	accent-ink	surface-1	5.53	4.5	+73	pass
mist	on-accent	accent-ink	5.98	4.5	-84	pass
paper	ink	ground	17.24	12	+102	pass
paper	ink	surface-1	18.00	12	+105	pass
paper	ink-2	ground	8.89	7	+88	pass

Catppuccin Mocha		26	9
Tokyo Night		15	6
Catppuccin Latte		23	10
GitHub Light		15	9
Solarized Light		22	10
Nord Light		25	11
Forest Green		32	17

Strip order: Source · 3D · Compositing · Effects · Modulators · Prediction · Macros · Utility · Notes · Synths · AudioEffects. Pairs are worst-case over normal, protan, deutan and tritan vision (tools/brand/category_audit.py).

Retired in v2

WAS	NOW	WHY
 #F5866B Coral (v1 accent on dark)	#FF6B35 Ember 400	owner-approved film palette r5/r6 moved the warm end to a cleaner orange; coral survives only as the gradient's first stop #F57F66
 #C2593F Terracotta	#D9430E Ember 500 (marks) / #B53700 Ember 600 (text, fills)	one warm hue on every mode; terracotta was a second warm family
 #A8472F Terracotta ink	#B53700 Ember 600	same hue as the accent, passes 4.5 on Paper and Mist
 #8B6CFF Violet glow	#A7B1FF Signal 300 or iridescence	owner r5: no violet on violet; two cool hues competed
 #F1D1A Warm ink	#12152A	one neutral family on the Midnight hue for every mode
 #5A534C Warm ink 2	#404660	one neutral family
 #6E6760 Warm ink 3	#5A6180	one neutral family
 #F3F0E7 Warm inner	#EFF0F4 paper deep	one neutral family
 #F1ECE2 Bone (film r5 ink)	#EEF1FA Moon	matches the app's own text colour; one neutral family
 #FF6B35 Ember as a ground	accent only	owner r6b: no orange ground
 #2A33A8 Cobalt ground	Paper	owner r6b picked Paper over Cobalt

Four voices, no fifth

Geist

400, 500, 600, 700, 800

Everything people read:
headlines, UI, body.

Geist Mono

400, 500

Machine text: values with units,
code, node types, folios,
coordinates.

Caveat

700

The one human word per scene
or section. Ember, hand
underline, 1.5x its neighbours.

Pixel

5 x 7

drawn

Drawn, not a font file. Only when
the machine itself speaks
(prediction, learning).

Text steps follow a major third (1.25); display steps jump about 1.5. Sizes are fluid between 375 and 1440 px viewports. Tracking tightens as size grows; mono and caps open up.

Display	Patch anything into anything	40→96 / 800 / 0.98 / -0.04em
H1	Patch anything into anything	32→61 / 750 / 1.04 / -0.035em
H2	Patch anything into anything	25→39 / 700 / 1.1 / -0.025em
H3	Patch anything into anything	20→25 / 650 / 1.2 / -0.015em
Lead	A cable carries a signal from one node to the next. 120 BPM, 4.00 ms.	18→20 / 450 / 1.45 / -0.005em
Body	A cable carries a signal from one node to the next. 120 BPM, 4.00 ms.	16→16 / 400 / 1.55 / +0em
Caption	A cable carries a signal from one node to the next. 120 BPM, 4.00 ms.	13.5→13.5 / 500 / 1.45 / +0.005em
Micro mono	A cable carries a signal from one node to the next. 120 BPM, 4.00 ms.	11.5→11.5 / 500 / 1.35 / +0.04em
Folio mono caps	A CABLE CARRIES A SIGNAL FROM ONE NODE TO THE NEXT. 120 BPM, 4.00 MS.	11→11 / 500 / 1.2 / +0.12em

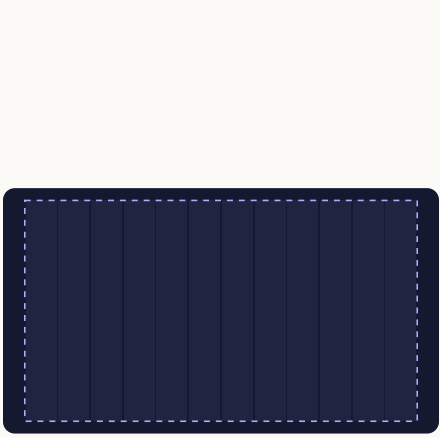
Film scale (4K stage)

STEP	PX	WEIGHT
Poster	60-100% of frame height	800
Display	300	800
Headline	196	800
Title	128	700
Line	96	700
Caption	64	500
Machine	44	500
Folio	32	500

Measure: body 60-72 ch, captions 30-45 ch. Kinetic type at most 15 characters per second.

Grids per format

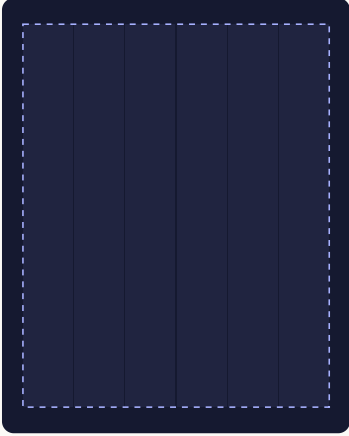
Web: 12 columns, max 1200, gutters 16/24/32, 8 px base. Film: 12 columns of 288 on a 3840 stage inside the 5% graphics-safe area. Social: 6% margins, 6 columns. Docs: A4, 18 mm margins, 4 pt baseline.



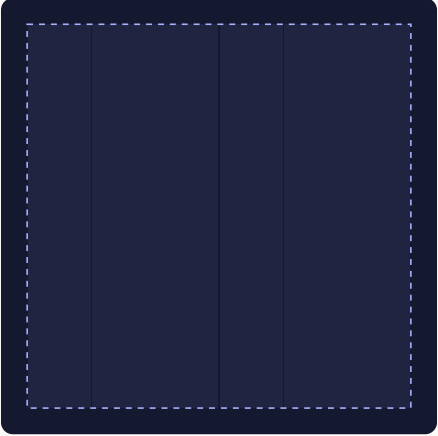
16:9 film: 12 columns of 288, graphics safe 5% (EBU R95)
3840×2160



9:16 owner box: top 14%, bottom 22%, right column clear 40-85%
1080×1920



4:5 social: 6% margin, 6 columns
1080×1350



1:1: 6% margin, 6 columns
1080×1080



GitHub social: 6% margin
1280×640



LinkedIn banner: keep the left 25% clear
1584×396

Concentric and borderless

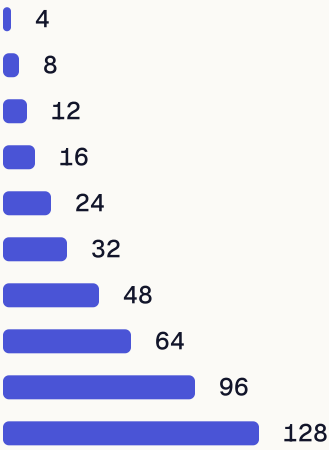
Card
24 px
Every card: node card, panel, film frame, step, modal. 20 on phones.

Media
16 px
Inside a card: card radius minus its 8 px padding. 12 on phones.

Chip
10 px
Code chips, tags, keycaps.

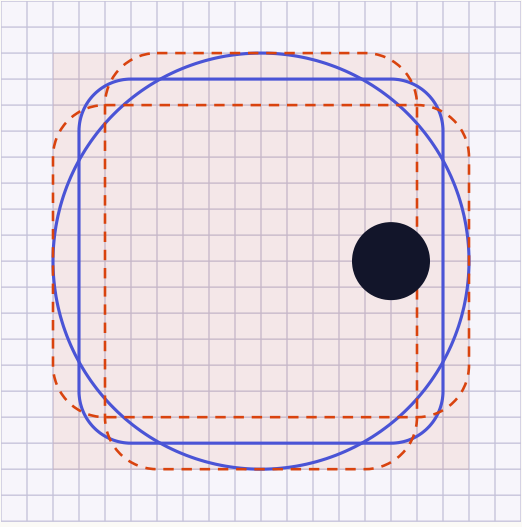
Control
pill
Buttons, chips, toggles, inputs: pill.

Inner radius = outer radius - padding (24 - 8 = 16). Space is an 8 px scale with 4 and 12 as half steps. Depth comes from surface steps and layered soft shadows, never from outlines.



LEVEL	MIDNIGHT	SHADOW
0	ground	none
1	surface-1	0 1px 1px a.04, 0 4px 10px a.05, 0 14px 32px a.06
2	surface-2	0 1px 2px a.06, 0 8px 20px a.08, 0 28px 60px a.10
3	surface-3	0 2px 4px a.08, 0 16px 40px a.12, 0 48px 96px a.14

20 grid, 1.5 stroke, one dot



Keylines: circle 16, square 14, portrait 12×16, landscape 16×12, 2 px padding. Stroke 1.25 at 16, 1.5 at 20, 1.75 at 24. Corners 2 outside, 1 inside. The 3 px dot is the same dot as a pin.

Pair with words

An icon alone only for universal actions (play, stop, record, close). Everywhere else a label sits beside it.

One family

Line by default; the -fill variant shows the on state, never decoration.

arrange	browser	capture	chevron-down	chevron-right	chevron-up	close	count-in	cube	edit	error	eye
eye-off	family-3d	family-audio-effects	family-compositing	family-effects	family-macros	family-modulators	family-notes	family-prediction	family-source	family-synths	family-utility
flag	folder	grid-dots	grip	hand	history	library	loop	metronome	metronome-body	mixer	mod-matrix
note-snap	pause	pencil	perform	placeholder	play	plus	pointer	power	range	record	refresh
rewind	scissors	search	settings	snap	star	stop	track-height	trim	viewport	warning	zoom

Motion that keeps time

The look can change; the movement cannot. Six laws, all computed in `tools/brand/motion.py`, make any move recognisably Infinite in any visual style: the transport is the clock, everything has the same mass, springs land on the beat, paths come from the mark.

LAW	RULE	MATHS	WHY
L1 Clock	Every duration is a note value at the transport tempo	$t = \text{beats} \times 60\,000 / \text{BPM}$; house 120 BPM, film = the track's BPM	Motion and music share one pulse; a token that is not a note is a bug (<code>motion.py --check</code>)
L2 Mass	One acceleration for every object	$T = 2\sqrt{(D/a)}$, $a = 2048 \text{ px/s}^2$, then snap to L1	Everything feels like the same weight on the same motor; long moves take longer, but not proportionally
L3 Spring	One damping ladder; ω scales with BPM/120	peak $t = \pi / (\omega\sqrt{(1-\zeta^2)})$; slab: 188 ms = 1/16 dotted	Start a slab a dotted 1/16 before the beat and the overshoot lands on it
L4 Path	Moves travel on arcs taken from the mark	leave at 22.5° (a quarter of the 90° crossing); $\text{bow} = \tan 11.25^\circ / 2 = 9.9\%$ of the chord	No straight-line travel; idle loops trace the lemniscate itself
L5 Phase	Loops last whole bars; siblings offset by the golden fraction	$\phi_i = i(1 - 1/\phi) \bmod 1 = 0, .382, .764, .146 \dots$	Many loops on screen never fall into step (Weyl equidistribution), yet each one loops cleanly
L6 Perception	Interpolate in the space the eye measures	zoom in $\log_2$, colour in OKLab, rotation by the shortest arc	A $1\times \rightarrow 8\times$ zoom spends equal time on each doubling; colour fades never go muddy

Live

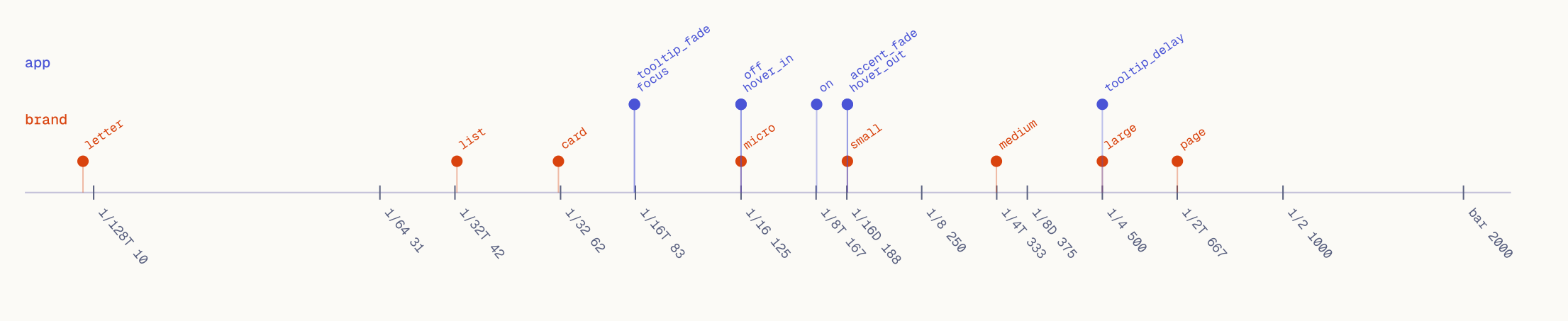


One loop = 4 bars (8 s). Three siblings start 0.382 and 0.764 of a loop apart, so they never move in step.



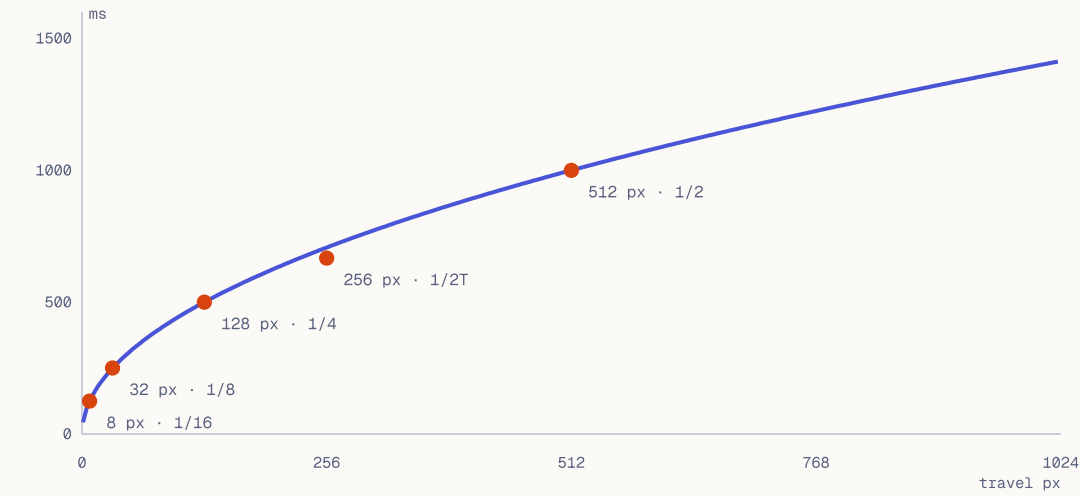
The slab spring lands once a bar (2000 ms). The dot flashes on the beat, 188 ms after launch: the overshoot peak, a dotted 1/16.

L1 · Clock



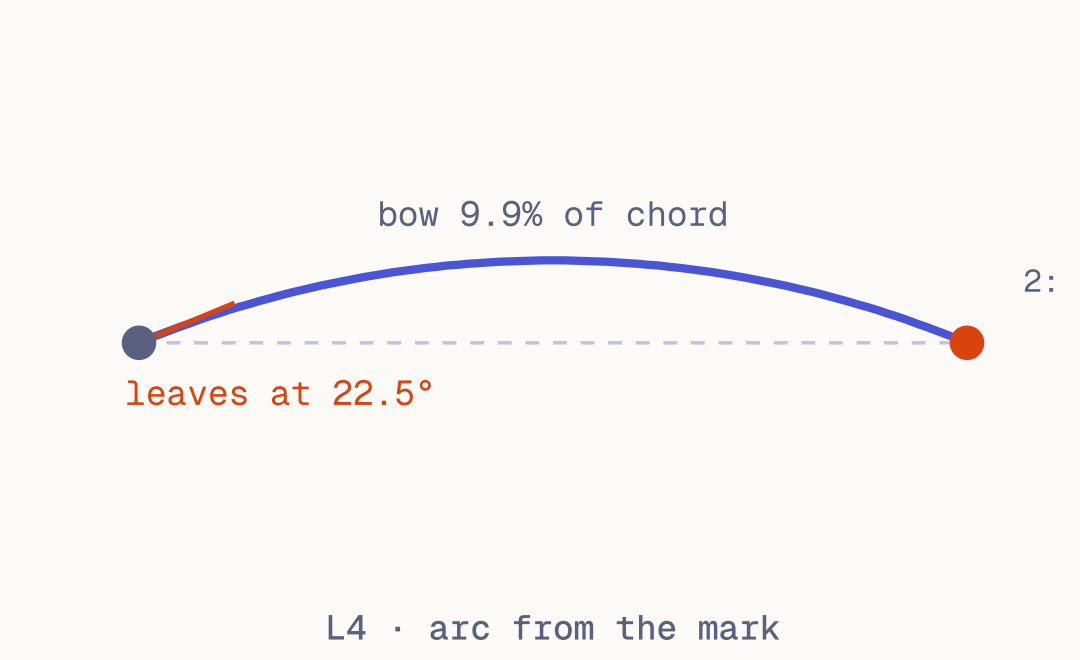
Every brand and app token sits on a note value at 120 BPM, the app's default tempo (log time axis). In films the tempo is the track's: scale every duration by $120 / \text{BPM}$, and spring ω by $\text{BPM} / 120$, so a move keeps its musical shape. The app's own UI always runs at 120.

L2 · Mass



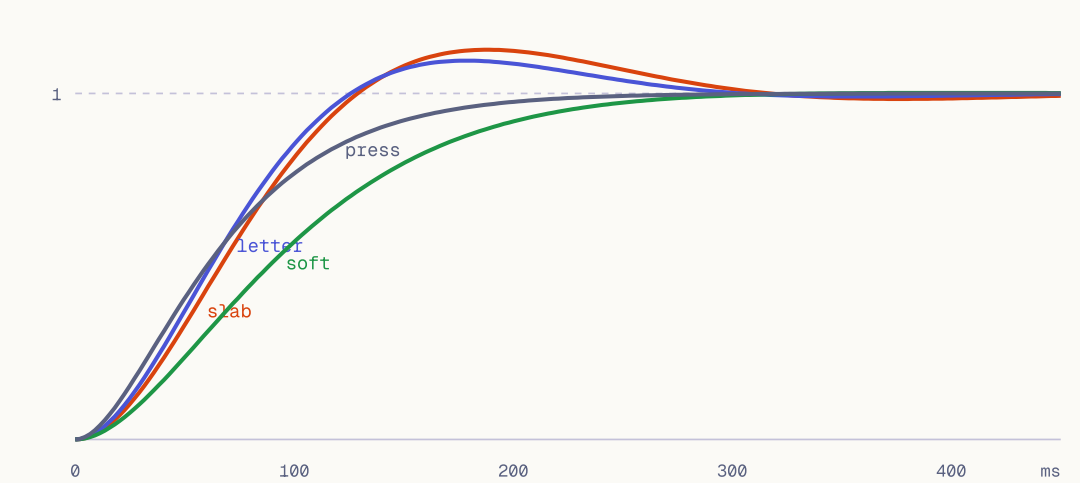
One acceleration for everything: an object speeds up for half the trip and brakes for the other half, so time grows with the square root of distance. 8 px is a 1/16, 32 px an 1/8, 128 px a 1/4, 512 px a 1/2. Use `motion.travel_ms(px, bpm)`.

L4 · Path and L5 · Phase



L3 · Springs

Overshoot = $\exp(-\pi\zeta/\sqrt{1-\zeta^2})$. Settle (2%) $\approx 4/(\zeta\omega)$. For SwiftUI, response = $2\pi/\omega$ and dampingFraction = ζ . For CSS, use the generated `linear()` curves in `brand.css`.



SPRING	ζ	Ω	OVERSHOOT	PEAK	SETTLE	SWIFTUI	USE
slab	0.55	20	12.6%	188 ms · 1/16D	292 ms	0.314 s / 0.55	Patch Type slabs, the key cable snap. The signature.
letter	0.6	22	9.5%	178 ms · 1/16D	271 ms	0.286 s / 0.6	Patch Type letters.
soft	0.9	18	0.2%	400 ms · 1/8D	262 ms	0.349 s / 0.9	Everything else that lands.
press	1.0	28	0.0%	-	209 ms	0.224 s / 1.0	Buttons, keycaps, knob detents (no overshoot).

Grammar

VERB	WHAT IT MEANS
Land	An object arrives and settles: soft spring, 4-8 u of travel, 188-333 ms (1/16 dotted to 1/4 triplet). Slabs and the key cable use the slab spring.
Patch	A cable draws from pin to pin: ease-out over 333-500 ms, plug snaps with the slab spring, the destination answers within 1/16 (125 ms).
Carry	Between scenes an object travels and becomes the next frame (iris, zoom to a rect, carried object). No cuts on a beat that has motion.
Live	Anything that shows a value keeps moving: knobs breathe $\pm 2^\circ$, waveforms scroll, meters fall. A frozen UI reads as a screenshot.
Breathe	One slow loop under everything, 2 or 4 bars (4 or 8 s at 120 BPM): the ball's iridescence, the gradient sweep. Never on type, stops for reduced motion.

Durations

TOKEN	MS	NOTE AT 120 BPM
instant	0	-
micro	125	1/16
small	188	1/16D
medium	333	1/4T
large	500	1/4
page	667	1/2T

In the app, motion stays at or under 200 ms and values never animate (they are data). Every brand motion stops for prefers-reduced-motion.

```
--spring-slab: linear(0, 0.017, 0.064, 0.133, 0.217, 0.311, 0.411, 0.511, 0.608, 0.699, 0.784, 0.859, 0.925, 0.98, 1.026, 1.062, 1.089, 1.108, 1.12, 1.126, 1
```

The node as an instrument

A node in 3D is a physical panel, like a pedal or a module, built from the app's own measurements. It is not a screenshot tilted in space. Reference: Audio Filter (src/app/bodies/FxBodies1.cpp, docs/plans/ui-system/element-sizes.md): body 440, readout strip 21, response viewer 190, row of 4 cells of 110 (type dropdown, freq, Q, gain), output row (mix, env).



Audio Filter, rendered from tools/brand/build_3d.py. Every size is from the app: 56 knobs in 110 cells, 190 viewer, 21 readout, 4 caption gap.

Process

01

Capture

Start from the real node: its body in code (sizes from element-sizes.md and AppShared.h), a screenshot at 100%, the live values a user would set.

02

Lay out flat

Rebuild the panel as vectors in app pixels: cells, wells, captions, pins. The top view must match the app before anything gets depth.

03

Assign a z

Every component gets one height from the z table. Wells go down, prints stay flush, controls come up, caps sit highest. Nothing floats.

04

Give it a material

Matte body, satin knobs, glossy display, printed type. Colour comes from the mode roles; category colour only on the title strip, jacks and cables.

05

Light it once

Key upper-left behind (135°, 50°), rim upper-right behind, fill from the camera. Shadows always on and soft, contact shadow 0.25.

06

Frame it

3/4 view, yaw 20-30°, pitch 25-35°, 50 mm. One angle family per film; the camera sweeps sideways, it does not orbit.

07

Make it live

Knobs turn with the soft spring, keys press with the press spring, the viewer and meters keep moving, the key cable lands with the slab spring.

08

Check side by side

Put the render next to the app screenshot. Same order, same labels, same values. If a control is missing or added, it is wrong.

Flat first, then depth

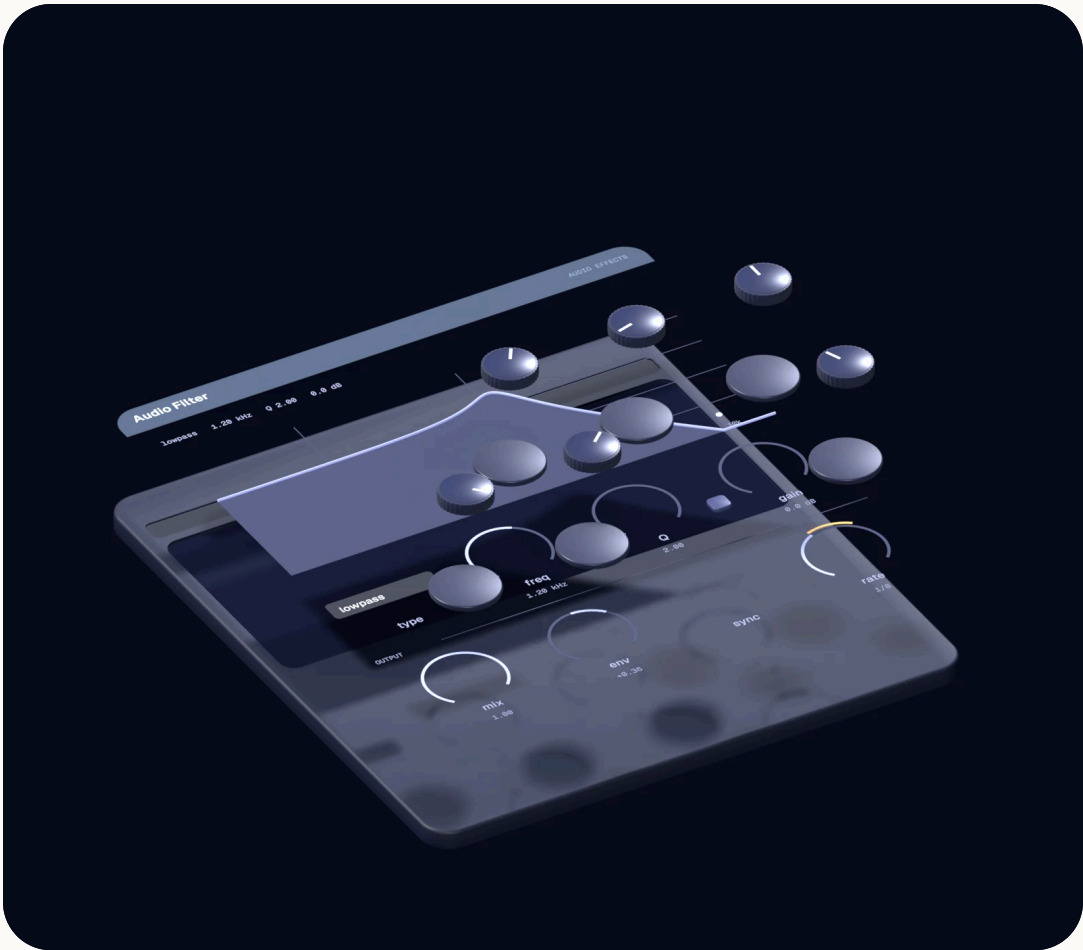


Step 2: the top view has to match the app before anything gets depth.

Anatomy



Knob: one size, 56. Skirt, knurled cap at 0.78 r, engraved Moon pointer, value arc printed on the panel in Signal, modulation arc outside it in the Modulation colour.



Steps 3-4: body, then printed layer (+0), controls, caps. Nothing floats in the final object.

COMPONENT		Z (U)	
display well		-3	
track		-2	
dropdown well		-1.5	
printed		+0	
jack ring		+1	
button on		+2.5	
switch		+4	
knob skirt		+4	
button rest		+6	
slider thumb		+7	
knob cap		+14	
MATERIAL	BASE	ROUGHNESS	
body	surface-1	0.55	
title	category at 18% over surface-1	0.5	
knob	#2A3052	0.38	
cap_top	#343B5E	0.3	
keycap	#2A3052	0.45	
display	#0D1020	0.08	glass coat
cable	source category colour; the key cable is Ember	0.35	
metal	#B8BED6	0.28	metal

Light and camera



	RULE
Key	135° az, 50° el, soft (5° sun angle)
Rim	45° az, 35° el, 0.6 of key
Fill	from the camera, 0.35 of key
Shadows	always on, contact 0.25, ground in the mode colour
Camera	yaw 20-30°, pitch 25-35°, 50 mm
Spec views	orthographic, yaw 30, pitch 35.264 (true isometric)
Colour	Standard view transform, so brand hexes stay true

What went wrong in the film, and the rule now

R7 FILM	V2 RULE
Flat textures skewed in 2.5D, so cards looked warped	Real geometry: an 18 u slab with a 3 u fillet, recessed wells, raised controls
Outlines on cards and controls	No outlines: edges come from the fillet catching the key light
Win95 bevel blocks for buttons	Pill keycaps on a shallow well: rest +6, pressed +2.5, LED for state
Dark cylinders for knobs, value arc floating in the air	Skirt + knurled cap + engraved Moon pointer; the arc is printed on the panel at 1.12 r
Labels baked tiny into a texture	Captions are printed geometry in Geist, 13 u, at the app's caption gap of 4
No shadows, objects floated, no key light	One key light, soft shadows on, contact shadow 0.25, ground in the mode colour
Glossy neon cables with big ball ends and glow	Matte 5 u tubes, real plugs seated in side-wall jacks, catenary sag to the floor, no glow

Animation

PART	MOTION
Knob	turns with the soft spring; idle breath $\pm 2^\circ$
Keycap	down 80 ms with press spring, up 140 ms; LED fades 160 ms
Switch	thumb slides with the soft spring, track tints over 160 ms
Cable	draws pin to pin with ease-out, plug seats with the slab spring (12.6% overshoot)
Viewer	always live: curve and meters keep moving

Assets you can reuse

All in art/brand/3d: glTF (metres, 1 app px = 1 mm), kit.blend, renders. Regenerate with python3 tools/brand/build_3d.py.



controls_kit.glb: every control from the element-size table at its app size.



logo_3d.glb: the two passes through the crossing separate by 1.24 strokes, so the loop reads over and under.



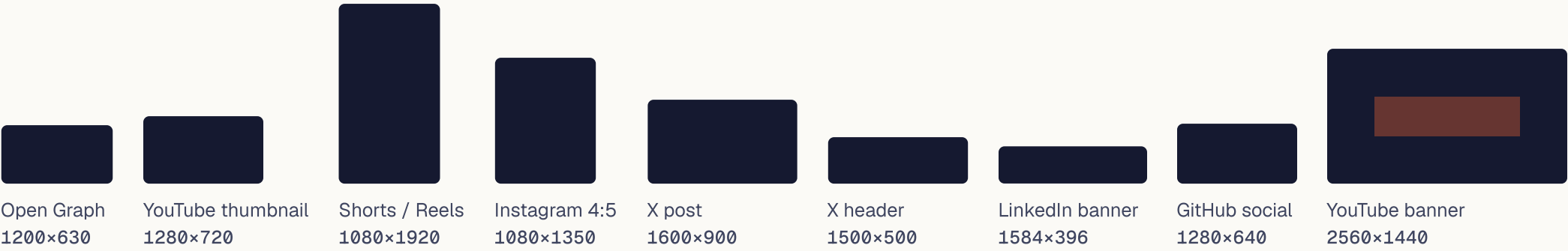
logo_tile.glb: Midnight tile, 18.5% corner, mark at 0.74 width (measured from the shipped icon).



brand_ball.glb: the one hero object, iridescence stops on a facing ramp under a clear coat.

FILE	WHAT
node_audio_filter.glb	the hero node with both cables
controls_kit.glb	knob, keycaps, switch, checkbox, dropdown, fader
logo_3d.glb	the loop
logo_tile.glb	app tile
brand_ball.glb	hero object
kit.blend	everything, with lights and cameras

Every place Infinite shows up



CHANNEL	ASSET	SIZE	MODE
Website	Open Graph image	1200x630	midnight
Website	Favicon	SVG + 32x32 + 180x180 touch	tile
YouTube	Video master	2560x1440 60 fps + 1920x1080	midnight
YouTube	Thumbnail	1280x720, under 2 MB	midnight
YouTube	Channel banner	2560x1440, safe 1546x423	midnight
YouTube Shorts / Reels / TikTok	Vertical video	1080x1920	midnight
Instagram	Feed post	1080x1350 (4:5), check the 3:4 grid crop	midnight or paper
X	Post image / video	1600x900 / 1920x1080	midnight
X	Header	1500x500	midnight
LinkedIn	Post image	1200x627 or 1080x1350	paper or midnight
LinkedIn	Banner	1584x396	midnight
GitHub	Social preview	1280x640	midnight
GitHub	README hero	1280x640 @2x, light and dark via <picture>	both
Release	Release notes	Markdown, sentence case, no em dashes	n/a
macOS	App icon	1024x1024 master, iconset 16 to 512 @2x	tile
macOS	DMG background	600x400 pt @2x (tools/dmg/make_background.py)	paper
Windows	ICO	16, 24, 32, 48, 64, 256	tile
Linux	ApplImage / desktop icon	SVG + 256 + 512 PNG	tile
Docs / PDF	Manual page	A4 and US Letter	paper
Press kit	Logo set	SVG, PNG 1024, mark + tile, light and dark	all
Email	Newsletter	600 px wide, live text, images @2x	paper
Slides	Deck	1920x1080	midnight or paper
Discord	Server icon / banner	512x512 / 960x540	tile / midnight

Plain and specific

	RULE
Units	Number, thin space, unit: 120 BPM, 4.00 ms, 1.20 kHz, -6.0 dB, 48 kHz / 24-bit
Dates	ISO in data and filenames (2026-10-10); 10 October 2026 in prose
Versions	v0.5.0 with the v; release names in sentence case
Node names	Exactly as the app spells them, Title Case: Audio Filter, Color Ramp, Liquid Glass
Keys	Cmd/Ctrl + K, keycap chips in mono; macOS first, then Windows/Linux
Files and code	Geist Mono: tools/brand/build_3d.py, .inf, P.y += bass * 2
Case	Sentence case for headings and buttons; lowercase for Patch Type slabs; mono caps only for folios
Punctuation	No em dashes, no exclamation marks, straight quotes in code, curly quotes in prose
Spelling	British in prose (colour, centre); node and API names keep the app's spelling
Numbers	Tabular figures for values that change; minus sign for negatives in display type

Say

A frosted glass pane that bends what is behind it. Patch anything into anything. A DAW for you.

Never

“The world's first”, “revolutionary”, exclamation marks, em dashes, “free for now”, a second accent colour, a card with an outline.

Where to spend attention

ASSETS		WHY
Invest	Lemniscate mark · Ember key cable · the digit bird · mono folio system	Unique and already recognised; use in every film and post
Keep	Brand gradient (logo only) · Caveat hand word · Patch Type slabs · iridescent ball	Distinctive but easy to overuse: one per frame
Restrain	Dot grid (texture only, ≤6% opacity) · frosted glass	Generic to the category; NN/g found translucency costs legibility
Retire	Violet glow · Instrument Serif · coral as accent · terracotta	Competed with Signal and Ember; diluted the two-ends idea

What the rules rest on

TOPIC	FINDING	SOURCE	RULE HERE
Colour space	OKLab / OKLCH	Ottosson 2020; CSS Color 4	Ramps keep perceived lightness at one hue; gamut mapped by chroma reduction
Contrast floor	WCAG 2.2 AA/AAA	W3C 2023	Build fails below the gate
Perceptual contrast	APCA Lc (guide only)	Removed from the WCAG 3 draft in 2023; WCAG 3 WD March 2026 still has no contrast method	Printed beside each pair, never used to pass
Colour vision	Machado, Oliveira, Fernandes 2009	IEEE TVCG	Ember vs Signal checked under protan, deutan, tritan
Polarity	Positive polarity reads faster	Piepenbrock et al. 2013	Reading surfaces are Paper; Midnight for showcase and film
Translucency	Glass hurts legibility	NN/g, Budiu, Liquid Glass, Oct 2025	Glass only behind short labels, 72-78% opacity, never behind body text
Expressive UI	Shape, colour and motion raise speed of finding key actions	Google Material 3 Expressive, 46 studies, 18,000+ people, 2025	One accent action per view, springs for state changes
Tokens	DTCG 2025.10, first stable	W3C Community Group, 28 Oct 2025	brand.tokens.json is emitted in that format
Aesthetic-usability	Beautiful UI is judged easier to use	Kurosu and Kashimura 1995	Polish is not decoration; it carries trust
Animation	Slow in/out, follow-through, squash	Chang and Ungar 1993; Thomas and Johnston 1981	Springs with measured overshoot, no linear moves
Motion: one mass	Constant-acceleration (bang-bang) travel, $T \propto \sqrt{D}$	Classical kinematics; Flash and Hogan 1985 on smooth reaching	L2: travel time from distance, snapped to the beat
Motion: magnitude	Equal ratios feel equal	Weber 1834; Fechner 1860	L6: zoom and scale in $\log_2$
Motion: loops	Irrational rotations never repeat	Weyl 1916, equidistribution	L5: golden phase offsets between sibling loops
Motion: sync	Sound may lead picture slightly; lagging hurts more	van Wassenhove, Grant, Poeppel 2007; ITU-R BT.1359	L1/L3: contact frames on the beat, sound 0-45 ms early
Response time	0.1 / 1 / 10 s; 400 ms	Nielsen 1993; Doherty and Thadani 1982	UI motion $\leq$ 200 ms, values never animate
Icons	Labels beat icons alone	Wiedenbeck 1999; McDougall et al. 2000	Icons pair with a label on first use and in menus
Line length	45-75 characters	Bringinghurst; Dyson 2004	Body measure 60-72 ch
Brand assets	Fame $\times$ uniqueness audit	Romaniuk, Building Distinctive Brand Assets, 2018	The invest / keep / restrain / retire table
Captions	$\leq$ 17 characters per second	Netflix timed-text guide; BBC subtitle guidelines	Kinetic type $\leq$ 15 cps
Safe areas	Action 3.5%, graphics 5%	EBU R95	Film grid